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Hiring Manager
GK News
New York, NY / Boston, MA

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm writing to apply for the Backend Engineer position at GK News. With over two years of experience building production web services and optimizing server-side systems, I'm excited about the opportunity to contribute to your confidential media analysis platform during this critical initial build phase.

My recent work directly aligns with your core requirements. At Centigrade, I rewrote critical API services in FastAPI and optimized database schemas to support a 5x increase in query throughput while reducing latency by 60%. This experience in performance optimization—profiling code, tuning database queries, and implementing caching strategies—mirrors the optimization focus outlined in your job description. I'm proficient in building robust RESTful APIs and have extensive experience with Python frameworks including FastAPI, Flask, and Django.

The media analysis platform's requirement for structured data outputs particularly resonates with my background. I've consistently worked with JSON and other structured formats, transforming complex data for frontend consumption. At CarbonSustain, I built Node.js and FastAPI microservices that delivered real-time transaction data to Angular frontends, implementing clean API contracts that enabled seamless frontend integration. This experience would translate directly to implementing server-side rendering logic for content highlighting and tagging.

Your preferred skills align well with my experience as well. I've deployed applications on AWS infrastructure using Docker and Terraform, managed PostgreSQL and MongoDB databases with careful attention to schema design and query efficiency, and worked in fast-paced startup environments where agile iteration and rapid delivery were essential. My background also includes text processing work—during my time at Belden, I developed LLM-powered systems that analyzed and tagged content for threat detection.

I understand the importance of NDA compliance and confidentiality, having worked on proprietary blockchain infrastructure and enterprise cybersecurity systems. I'm comfortable working under strict confidentiality requirements and maintaining the security standards necessary for sensitive projects.

The opportunity to be a core contributor on a small team building a system from scratch is exactly what I'm looking for. I thrive in environments where my work has immediate, visible impact, and I'm eager to learn under the guidance of your Lead Engineer while taking ownership of significant technical components.

I'm based in the Bay Area but am fully flexible for hybrid work in either Boston or NYC, or remote collaboration as needed. I'm available to start immediately and can commit to the full-time engagement for the initial month and beyond.

I'd welcome the opportunity to discuss how my backend development experience and optimization skills can contribute to the success of your media analysis platform. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Kentaro Vadney